

Pushing Back
On Assessment
Of Iran Strikes

Rubio Insists Nuclear
Program Is Gutted

By DAVID E. SANGER and TYLER PAGER

THE HAGUE — President Trump and Secretary of State Marco Rubio made their most detailed case yet on Wednesday at a NATO summit in the Netherlands for why they believe the American attack on Iran dealt a fatal blow to its nuclear ambitions, pushing back on the findings of a U.S. intelligence report and more cautious statements from international nuclear inspectors.

While Mr. Trump largely repeated his assertions that Iran's nuclear facilities were “obliterated,” Mr. Rubio stepped in with the first description of why he thought the attack had set back the Iranians’ progress for years rather than by only a few months, as a preliminary Defense Intelligence Agency report said. His argument centered on evidence that a “conversion facility” — which is key to converting nuclear fuel from a gas into the form needed to produce a nuclear weapon — has been destroyed.

The question of whether Iran could recover from the strike on Sunday morning dominated the meeting of the 32 NATO nations. It overshadowed a major accomplishment for Mr. Trump: an agreement among most of the allies, with the notable exception of Spain, to spend 5 percent of their gross domestic product on defense within a decade as they face down Russian military aggression. Mr. Trump had demanded the increase and celebrated the moment, telling reporters during an hourlong news conference, “I began pushing for additional commitments in 2017.”

But his anger over the disclosure of the intelligence report on

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COMMITMENT NATO vows to increase military spending, pleasing President Trump. PAGE A5

AN OPEN BOOK Online and in real life, President Trump offers a window into his psyche. PAGE A5

Kennedy Stops
Vaccine Money
To World Group

By STEPHANIE NOLEN

The U.S. health secretary, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., who has moved to undermine public immunization programs in the United States, took his efforts global on Wednesday, accusing the leading international vaccine organization of having “ignored the science” in immunizing children around the world.

In confrontational remarks sent by video to global leaders who had gathered to support the organization, Gavi, Mr. Kennedy said the United States would withdraw its financial support for the group's work purchasing vaccines for children in poor countries.

“When vaccine safety issues have come before Gavi, Gavi has treated them not as a patient health problem, but as a public relations problem,” Mr. Kennedy said in the address. He offered no evidence for the allegation.

His speech was the first indication that the Trump administration's decision to end funding for Gavi may be motivated by mistrust of vaccines, in addition to a desire to reduce foreign aid.

In the video, which Gavi's leaders said they would play before the end of the summit, Mr. Kennedy accused them of being selec-

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Hopes Dashed on H.I.V.
U.S. funding cuts doomed plans for wide African distribution of a new drug to protect against the virus. PAGE A10

Kenya Protests Leave 8 Dead
Demonstrators battled with police nationwide a year after deadly rallies against a contentious tax plan. PAGE A8



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As they push for cuts in Medicaid and food stamps, Republicans are betting they can avoid backlash from supporters who use those programs. PAGE A17

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As the Trump administration dismantles the Voice of America, adversaries are only too happy to fill the void. PAGE B1

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Supporters of incentives for wind and solar — many in Republican districts — are fighting efforts to kill them. PAGE B1

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From Broadway to the MAC
Eddie George has won the Heisman Trophy, starred in the N.F.L., started businesses and acted onstage. His new role: coaching Bowling Green. PAGE B6

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Focused on City's 'Bad Boys'
Marcia Resnick photographed the swirling 1970s social scene, including John Belushi. She was 74. PAGE B10

Teen Idol of 1960s and '70s
Bobby Sherman, an actor and a singer who became an easygoing pop-music star, was 81. PAGE B11

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Trump and the Gay Community
Gay backers of the president say that he is indifferent to sexuality. Many L.G.B.T.Q. activists disagree. PAGE D1

She's Still Fitting In
The influencer Katie Sturino is losing weight, but that doesn't mean she is not “body neutral” anymore. PAGE D4



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The Russian ballerina Olga Smirnova lit up the start of the American Ballet Theater's summer season. PAGE C1

Tale of Heroism in Chechnya
The makers of a film about the murdered Russian activist Natalya Estemirova had to take their own risks. PAGE C1

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MAMDANI VOWS TO UNITE CITY'S DEMOCRATS



Zohran Mamdani, who stunned Andrew M. Cuomo in a New York primary, will try to unseat Mayor Eric Adams, an independent.

A Sudden Acceleration Puts a Beleaguered Party at a Crossroads

By LIAM STACK

The national Democratic establishment on Tuesday night struggled to absorb the startling ascent of a democratic socialist in New York City who embraced a progressive economic agenda and diverged from the party's dominant position on the Middle East.

As elections go, Tuesday's party primary for mayor was a thunderbolt: New York voters turned away from a well-funded familiar face and famous name, former Gov. Andrew M. Cuomo, and in doing so made a generational and ideological break with the party's mainstream. They turned to a 33-year-old, three-term state assemblyman, Zohran Mamdani, who ran on an optimistic message that has eluded many national Demo-

crats about affordability and the rising cost of living.

What became vividly clear on Tuesday, as votes were counted across the racially and economically diverse neighborhoods of New York, was that Mr. Mamdani had generated excitement among some — though not all — of the traditional pillars of winning Democratic voter coalitions.

Democratic leaders badly want to win over young voters and minority groups in the coming 2026 and 2028 elections — two groups they have struggled to mobilize since the Obama era — but they also need moderate Democrats and independents who often recoil from far-left positions.

“It really represents the excitement that I saw on the streets all throughout the City of New York,”

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Supporters celebrated Mr. Mamdani's victory at a Democratic Socialists of America watch party on Tuesday night in Brooklyn.

As Bezos Weds, Superyachts Join the Gondolas

By EMMA BUBOLA

VENICE — Private jets soared above Venice's archipelago, and towering superyachts slipped through its lagoon. Caterers baked buttery Venetian delicacies while protesters schemed. Bomb-sniffing dogs prowled the verdant island of San Giorgio Maggiore, in front of the Doge's Palace.

Venice, the city built by merchants and tradesmen, girded itself this week for the nuptials of the doge of digital commerce.

A Grandiose Gathering
Irks an Opulent City

Jeff Bezos, the billionaire tech entrepreneur, newspaper owner turned jacked tabloid fixture and A-list mingler, was set to celebrate his wedding to the energetic broadcaster Lauren Sánchez in a city that centuries ago set the standard for sumptuous, flashy ostentation.

For three days starting Thursday, the frescoed ancient homes of bankers and tradesmen that made Venice rich, now emptied of their residents and brimming with scented orchids, are to be turned over to influencers, rappers, pop stars and Ivanka Trump — all among the expected guests.

San Giorgio, where emperors once met with popes, would host the patron of Amazon.com.

City officials were proud, happy about the money and the prestige

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The Grand Canal in Venice. When the private jets soar and the superyachts moor, that's amore.

Global Deals, Cash and Pressure
Help Trump Offload Deportees

This article is by Edward Wong, Zolan Kanno-Youngs, Hamed Aleaziz and Minho Kim.

WASHINGTON — U.S. diplomats in several overseas missions received an urgent cable from Washington this spring. They were told to ask nine countries in Africa and Central Asia to take in people expelled from the United States who were not citizens of those nations, including criminals.

It was a glimpse into President Trump's wide campaign to get countries to accept America's deportees. American diplomats are reaching out to countries in every corner of the globe, even some shattered by war or known for human rights abuses.

U.S. officials have approached Angola, Mongolia and embattled Ukraine. Kosovo has agreed to accept up to 50 people. Costa Rica is holding dozens.

The U.S. government paid Rwanda \$100,000 to take an Iraqi man and is discussing sending more deportees there. Peru has said no so far, despite having been pressed repeatedly.

“The United States is eager to partner with countries willing to accept” people, the cable, dated March 12, said. It listed Tunisia, Togo and Turkmenistan among the possible destinations.

And the administration re-

cently planned to fly citizens of mainly Asian and Latin American countries to war-torn Libya and South Sudan, until a U.S. district court blocked those expulsions. Libya was one of the nine countries mentioned in the cable, which has not been reported previously.

The Supreme Court ruled on Monday that the Trump administration has the right to expel people to countries other than their



The immigration police at a detention facility in Costa Rica.

own, possibly paying the way for the deportation flight to South Sudan and similar moves across the globe.

“Fire up the deportation planes,” Tricia McLaughlin, a spokeswoman for the Homeland Security Department, wrote on

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